



How did the HDB Resale Portal affect property agents from the resale market?

Data suggest the portal changed how transactions were conducted short-term, but did not necessarily eliminate the role of property agents.

The HDB Resale Portal

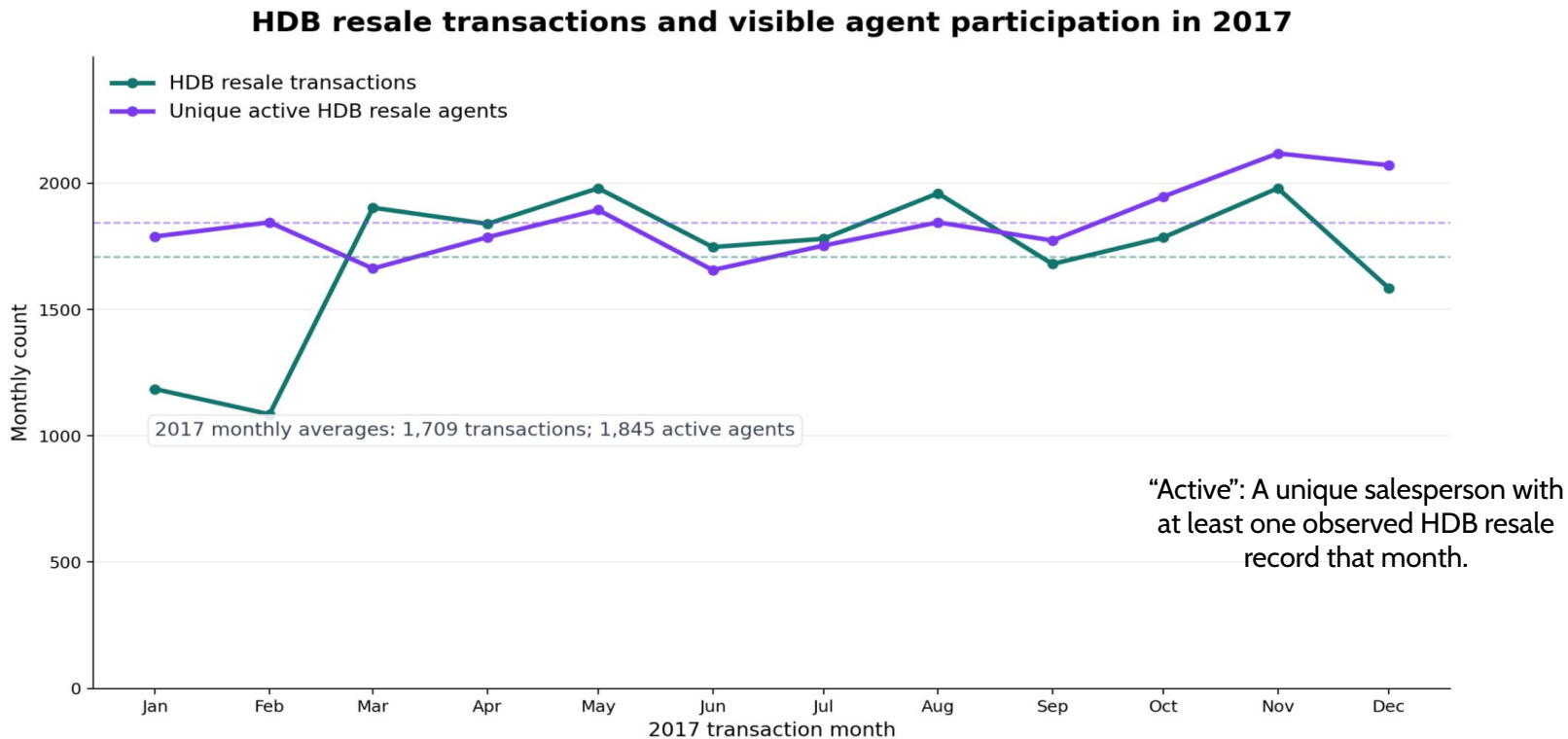
Launched in **January 2018**, the HDB Resale Portal streamlined resale transactions by enabling buyers and sellers to complete eligibility checks, submit documents and track applications through a single platform.

This raised concerns that greater self-service could reduce the role of property agents in the resale market.



Pre-launch: Property Agent Demand in the resale market

The resale market already had visible agent participation: For every resale transaction, there was 1.52 agents active in the resale market



How to quantify impact?

01 Number of Agents active in the resale market

Did fewer agents participate in HDB resale transactions?

02 Number of HDB Resale records per agent

Did agents handle fewer transactions?

03 Gross Commission per active agent

Did agents earn less commission?

Timeline of analysis



Pre-launch Numbers (Aug-Dec 2017)

1,950

**Number of Agents active
in the resale market**

1.43

**Number of HDB Resale
records per agent**

\$10,200

**Gross Commission
per active agent**

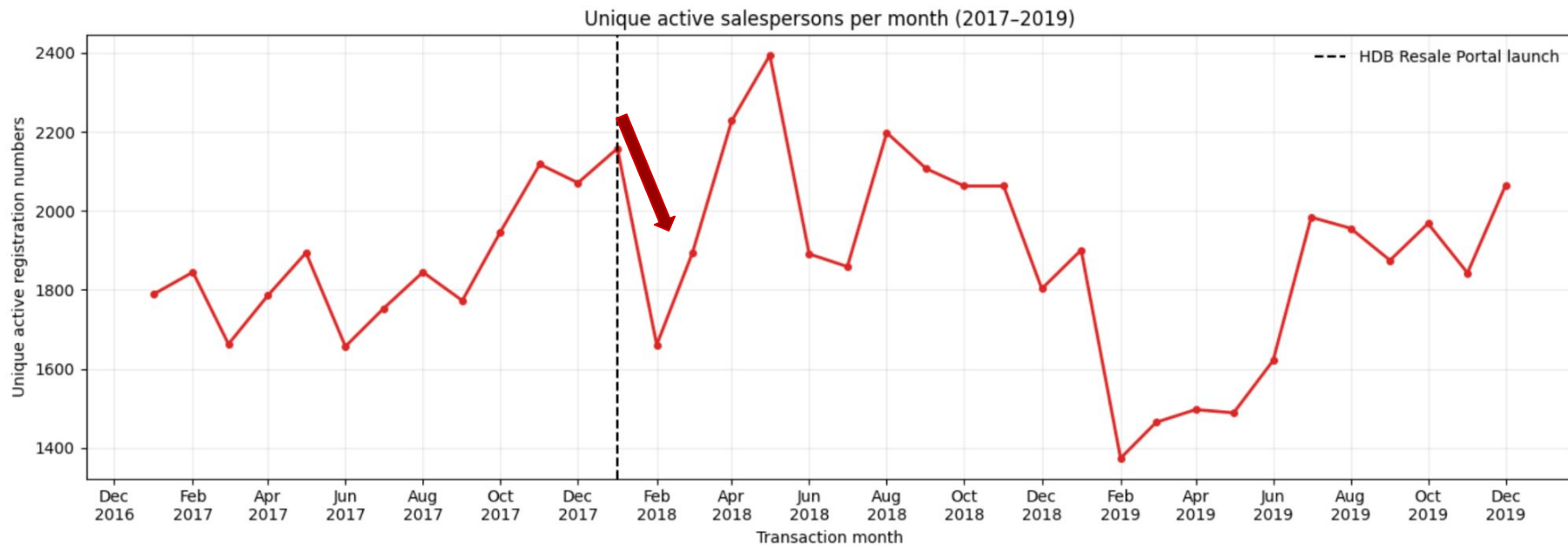
Definition of each metric:

1. Average number of agents with at least one resale transaction recorded in 2017
2. Average of Number of HDB resale transactions recorded/Number of active agents
3. Monthly average estimated gross commission per active HDB resale agent. For each agent-month, the method sums town-month imputed HDB value multiplied by a 2% seller-side rate or 1% buyer-side rate, then averages across active HDB resale agents. (Source: EdgeProp)

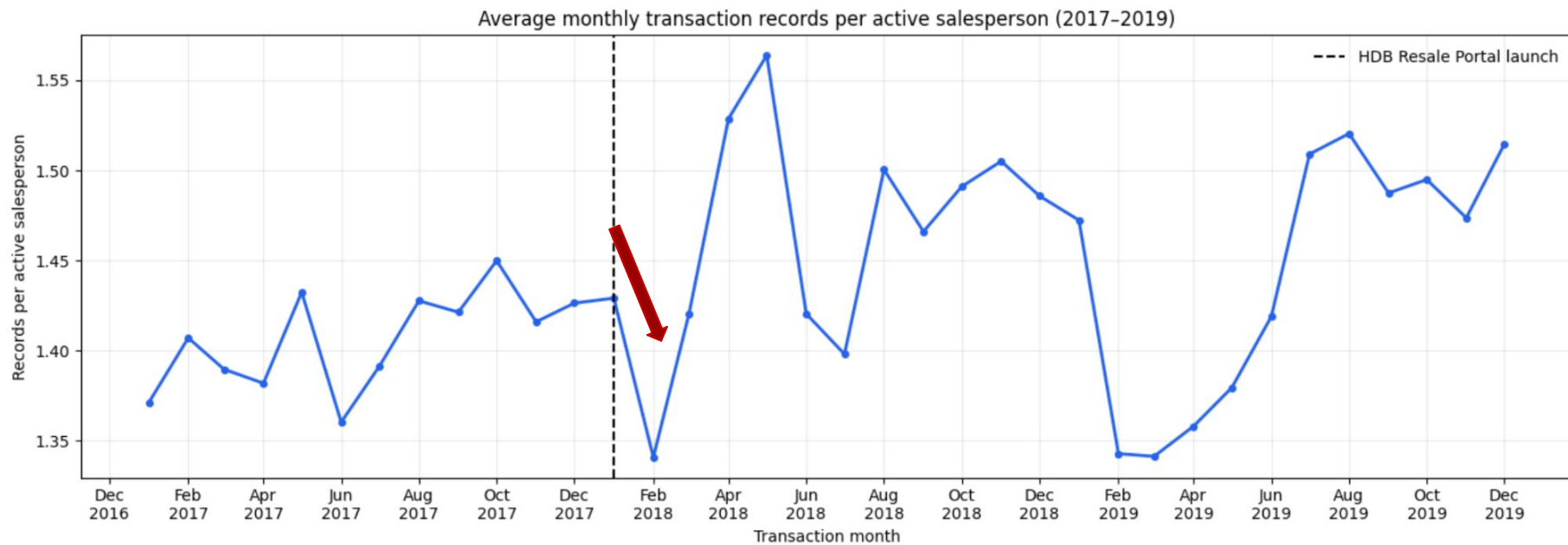
The portal launch coincided with a clear short-term decline across all three measures



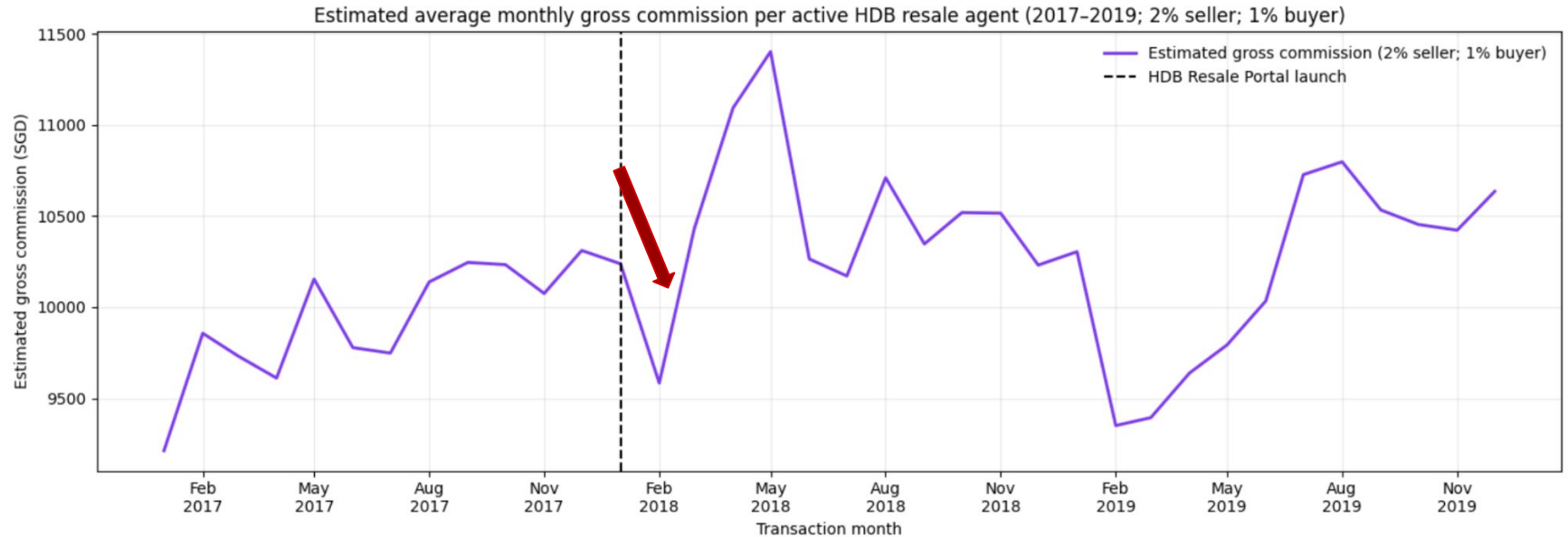
Number of Agents active in the resale market



Number of HDB Resale records per agent



Gross Commission per active agent



But that is not the full picture

Within 2-5 months, all three measures were **above pre-launch baseline**.

Number of active agents rebounded to 2,101 per month. (+7.71%)

Resale records per active agent rose to 1.48 (+3.87%)

Estimated monthly gross commission per active agent reached S\$10,797 (+5.85%)

ACTIVE AGENTS

2,101.25

monthly average

+7.71%

RECORDS / AGENT

1.483

monthly average

+3.87%

GROSS COMMISSION / AGENT

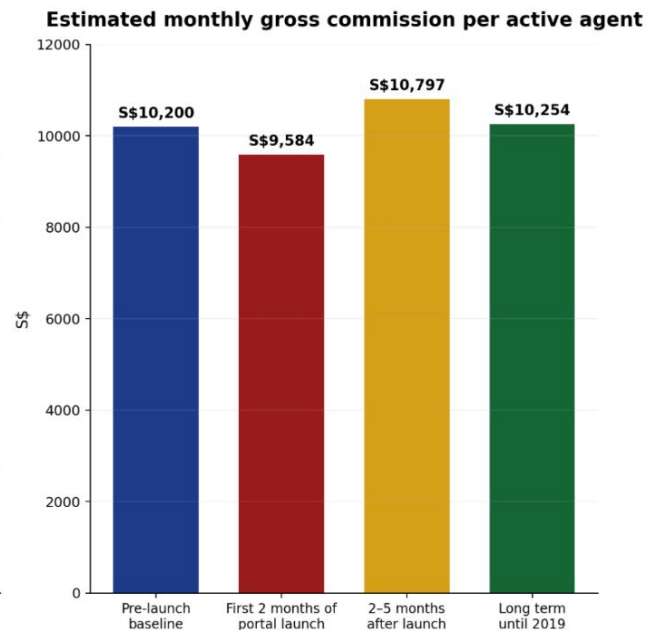
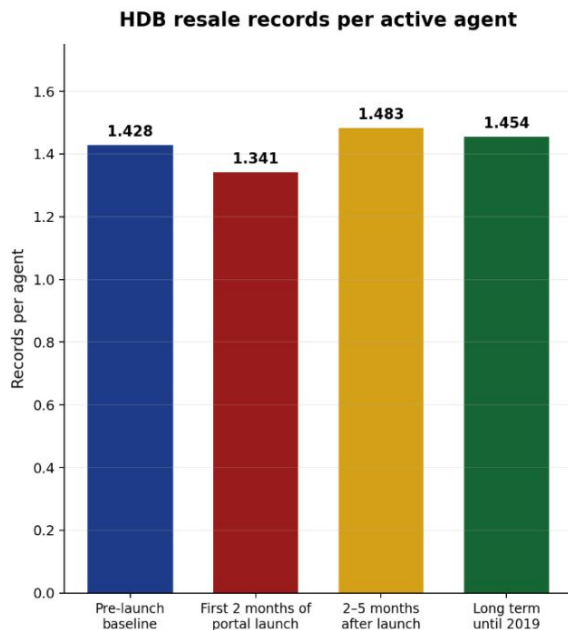
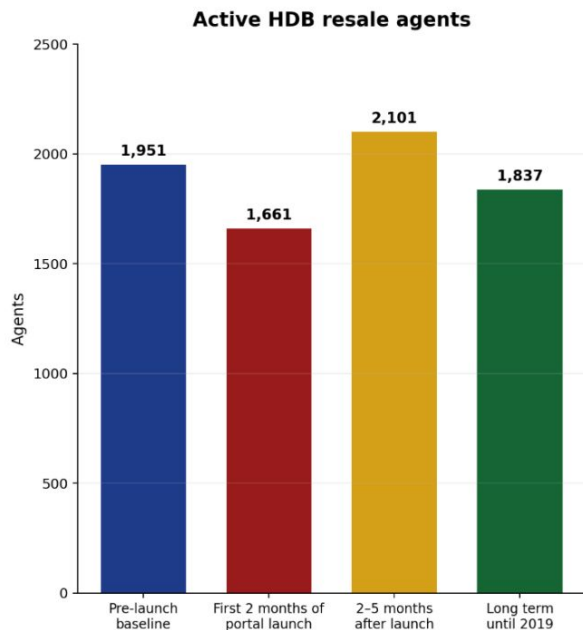
S\$10,797

estimated monthly

+5.85%

Over the longer term, agents' business remained stable.

Other than average number of active agents, other measures moved back to the pre launch range in the long term until 2019.



Over the longer term, agents' business remained stable.

For number of agents, the most pronounced decline appeared in February 2019—over a year after the portal's launch. Its timing makes it difficult to attribute the decline directly to the portal, as seasonal patterns and wider market conditions may also have played a role.



Data Limitations and Further Exploration

Limitations and Caveats:

- Descriptive analysis only; no causal proof is done from this analysis
- Estimated commission do not account for commission splits, or agency fees
- One resale transaction might have multiple agents involved from seller/buyer side

Further Exploration

1. **Who still chooses an agent?** Some buyer/seller segments/demographics might be more likely to engage property agents
2. **What value do agents provide?** To do this, we can compare transaction outcomes with/without agents. But this would need a more comprehensive database that labels each resale transaction with whether agents are involved

Key Takeaways and Summary

Data suggests that agents remained relevant in resale transactions despite a short-term disruption, and there is no clear evidence of sustained displacement.

FOR PROPERTY AGENTS

A more digital process can remove some paperwork friction, but it does not automatically remove the need for pricing advice, negotiation, reassurance, and transaction coordination. Through the end of 2019, the descriptive evidence does not show those roles disappearing from HDB resale.

FOR BUYERS AND SELLERS

The portal can still be good news for households. It can make the process more transparent and give people more choice over how much support they want, whether that means doing more themselves or using an agent selectively when they need help.